Knowledge organiser (TRACK) — Studio skills and safe workshop practice

Pathway: TRACK · Week 2 Part 2 · Big question: How do we score, cut, and laminate heavy card safely to build rigid architectural relief?

Core studio focus

Family: Studio suite

Big question: How do we score, cut, and laminate heavy card safely to build rigid architectural relief?

• Demonstrate safe workshop setup using cutting mats, safety rulers, and controlled scoring.

• Construct raised structural girders using laminated card strips and slotted gusset joins.

• Apply a unifying tonal wash or dry-brush primer across the assembled relief study.

Essential vocabulary

• score: To press or lightly indent a line along card so it folds or snaps cleanly.

• laminate: To glue two or more layers of card together for extra thickness and strength.

• gusset: A small angled corner plate that reinforces where two beams meet.

• safety ruler: A ruler with a raised finger guard used to guide straight cuts safely.

• primer: A base coat of paint or wash that unifies mixed card surfaces.

Three-step studio method

Step 1: Safe stance and straight strip cutting: I stand up over my cutting mat, tuck my fingers behind the safety ruler guard, and cut even girder strips.

Step 2: Laminate and add gusset plates: I glue two strips together for a deep main beam and lock diagonal braces with triangle gusset plates.

Step 3: Apply dark primer and metallic skim: I brush a thin dark grey coat over the card joins so the whole structure reads as solid ironwork.